

Opening Books

The GM Bestseller Shelf

A broad, computer-era reference library for an AI chess coach - selected for coverage, authority, explanatory value, and concrete theoretical depth.

39

curated GM-authored titles

38

official excerpts installed

9

coverage shelves

Prepared 20 July 2026

Local En Croissant document library

What this shelf is

This is a deliberately broad opening reference shelf, not a personalized repertoire. It spans general opening literacy, White repertoires after 1.e4, 1.d4, 1.c4 and 1.Nf3, Black's major replies to 1.e4 and 1.d4, and the sidelines that otherwise fall between specialist books.

The corpus mixes three source styles. **Explanatory** books are the best first source for coaching language and durable ideas. **Hybrid** books combine plans with serious analysis. **Reference** books are best for exact move orders and critical lines. A future retrieval system should prefer explanatory and hybrid passages when answering 'why', while using reference books to verify concrete recommendations.

Source style	Books	Best use
Explanatory	2	Concepts, plans, preparation method, opening character
Hybrid	20	Teaching plus concrete lines and model positions
Reference	17	Move orders, critical tests, theoretical verification

Rights and installation status

38 publisher-authorized sample PDFs are installed locally. The catalogue is not claiming that these excerpts are full books. Full editions should only be added from copies you lawfully purchase or already own, and the local corpus should never be redistributed.

Suggested acquisition order

If buying the full editions over time, start with books that teach durable concepts across many openings, then add a broad theory spine, and finally specialist depth. This order is optimized for a coaching corpus, not for building a single player's repertoire.

Stage	Books	Why
Phase 1 - Teaching spine	FCO; Grandmaster Opening Preparation; Bologan's Black Weapons; Bologan's Ruy Lopez; The Powerful Catalan; Marin's English trilogy; Marin's Pirc; Bologan's Caro-Kann; Jones's King's Indian pair.	Highest prose density and broadest lesson value.
Phase 2 - Main-line reference spine	Negi's five-volume 1.e4 set; Avrukh's four-volume 1.d4 set; Roiz's Berlin, Nimzo-Indian and Queen's Indian; Pavlidis's Taimanov; Schandorff's Semi-Slav.	Concrete coverage of the major theoretical battlegrounds.
Phase 3 - Specialist breadth	Berg's French trilogy; The Modern Tiger; The Modernized Sicilian Kan; Modern Benoni; Leningrad Dutch plus Dutch Sidelines; The Safest Gruenfeld; minor-opening and London volumes.	Closes coverage gaps and adds distinctive pawn structures.

Retrieval rules for the future coach

1. Retrieve by position and pawn structure, not only by opening name.
2. Prefer explanatory passages for lesson synthesis; use reference volumes to support exact lines.
3. Cite title, author, and page for every derived lesson, and label any engine conclusion separately.
4. Treat recommendations as the author's repertoire choice, not universal truth.
5. When books disagree, surface the disagreement and compare publication date, move order, and engine evidence.
6. Keep excerpts short in generated study packs; point back to the lawfully owned source for context.

The complete shelf

Status shows what is installed today. The title links lead to an official publisher or retailer page where available.

01 General and Method (2)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
FCO: Fundamental Chess Openings Paul van der Sterren (GM) Gambit Publications, 2009	All major openings for both sides; plans, character, and essential variations The one-volume map of the whole opening landscape and the best first retrieval source for plans and opening character.	Explanatory Official excerpt installed Foundation priority
Grandmaster Opening Preparation Jaen Ehvest (GM) Quality Chess, 2018	How strong players research, test, remember, and deploy openings in the computer era Adds the missing meta-layer: how to prepare openings rather than merely what moves to play.	Explanatory Official excerpt installed Foundation priority

02 White - 1.e4 (5)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs the French, Caro-Kann and Philidor Parimarjan Negi (GM) Quality Chess, 2014	White repertoire against the French, Caro-Kann, and Philidor A flagship main-line 1.e4 repertoire from an elite theoretician.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs the Sicilian I Parimarjan Negi (GM) Quality Chess, 2015	White repertoire against the Najdorf Sicilian Deep, influential coverage of the most important Sicilian battleground.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs the Sicilian II Parimarjan Negi (GM) Quality Chess, 2015	White repertoire against the Dragon, Classical, Sveshnikov, and Kalashnikov Completes the sharp 2...d6 and 2...Nc6 Sicilian families not covered by volume I.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs the Sicilian III Parimarjan Negi (GM) Quality Chess, 2016	White repertoire against the Taimanov, Kan, Four Knights, and Scheveningen Rounds out the open-Sicilian shelf with the major 2...e6 systems.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: 1.e4 vs Minor Defences Parimarjan Negi (GM) Quality Chess, 2020	White repertoire against the Alekhine, Scandinavian, Pirc, Modern, and minor first-move defences Closes the practical gaps in a serious 1.e4 reference shelf.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority

03 White - 1.d4 (5)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Grandmaster Repertoire 1A: The Catalan Boris Avrukh (GM) Quality Chess, 2015	Catalan repertoire for White A canonical modern Catalan reference from the author who reshaped repertoire-book standards.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 1B: The Queen's Gambit Boris Avrukh (GM) Quality Chess, 2016	White repertoire after 1.d4 d5, including Queen's Gambit systems Broad main-line 1.d4 coverage against the classical 1...d5 complex.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Grandmaster Repertoire 2A: King's Indian and Gruenfeld Boris Avrukh (GM) Quality Chess, 2018	White repertoire against the King's Indian and Gruenfeld Modern White-side treatment of the two central dynamic Indian defences.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 2B: Dynamic Systems Boris Avrukh (GM) Quality Chess, 2019	White repertoire against the Dutch, Benoni, Benko, Budapest, and other dynamic systems Completes Avrukh's broad White repertoire against unbalanced Black systems.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
The Powerful Catalan Victor Bologan (GM) New In Chess, 2012	A complete Catalan repertoire with strategic and tactical explanations A more prose-rich Catalan companion to Avrukh's dense reference work.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority

04 White - English and Reti (4)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Grandmaster Repertoire 3: The English Opening Volume One Mihail Marin (GM) Quality Chess, 2009	English Opening for White after 1.c4 e5 A celebrated mix of deep analysis and Marin's unusually strong strategic explanations.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 4: The English Opening Volume Two Mihail Marin (GM) Quality Chess, 2010	English Opening for White against 1...c5 and related symmetrical systems Adds the strategically distinct Symmetrical English family.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 5: The English Opening Volume Three Mihail Marin (GM) Quality Chess, 2010	English Opening for White against remaining Black systems and transpositions Completes one of the most respected full English repertoires.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
The Modern Reti: An Anti-Slav Repertoire Alexander Delchev (GM) Chess Stars, 2012	Reti move orders and an Anti-Slav repertoire for White A flexible, understanding-first repertoire explicitly designed for the computer era.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority

05 Black - 1.e4 e5 (3)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Bologan's Black Weapons in the Open Games Victor Bologan (GM) New In Chess, 2014	Black repertoire after 1.e4 e5 when White avoids the Ruy Lopez A worldwide bestseller with two repertoire options, fast lanes, traps, transpositions, and coach-friendly explanations.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Foundation priority
Bologan's Ruy Lopez for Black Victor Bologan (GM) New In Chess, 2015	Black repertoire in the Ruy Lopez based on the Marshall and Breyer The bestselling companion to Black Weapons, combining concrete lines with strategic signposts.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Berlin Defence Michael Roiz (GM) Quality Chess, 2021	Complete Berlin Defence repertoire for Black A modern specialist reference for the most important sound alternative to Bologan's Marshall and Breyer.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority

06 Black - Sicilian (2)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Sicilian Taimanov Antonios Pavlidis (GM) Quality Chess, 2019	Complete Taimanov Sicilian repertoire for Black A rigorous, modern Black-side Sicilian built on the author's long practical experience.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
The Modernized Sicilian Kan Adrien Demuth (GM) Thinkers Publishing, 2021	Complete Sicilian Kan repertoire for Black A modern, flexible Sicilian companion that emphasizes move orders and characteristic plans.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority

07 Black - Other vs 1.e4 (6)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Bologan's Caro-Kann Victor Bologan (GM) New In Chess, 2018	Complete Caro-Kann repertoire for Black with multiple options in many lines A widely recommended single-volume Caro-Kann reference with engine-tested lines and clear prose.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 14: The French Defence Volume One Emanuel Berg (GM) Quality Chess, 2013	French Winawer repertoire excluding the main 7.Qg4 complex Part one of a landmark three-volume French repertoire by a lifelong specialist.	Reference Acquire full edition - no PDF sample Specialist priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 15: The French Defence Volume Two Emanuel Berg (GM) Quality Chess, 2014	French Winawer 7.Qg4 systems for Black The critical tactical core of Berg's French trilogy.	Reference Official excerpt installed Specialist priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 16: The French Defence Volume Three Emanuel Berg (GM) Quality Chess, 2015	French Tarrasch, Advance, Exchange, and remaining White systems Completes the French shelf with the non-Winawer systems encountered most often in practice.	Reference Official excerpt installed Specialist priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Pirc Defence Mihail Marin (GM) Quality Chess, 2017	Complete Pirc repertoire for Black Combines a lifetime of practical Pirc experience with Marin's first-rate strategic teaching.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
The Modern Tiger Tiger Hillarp Persson (GM) Quality Chess, 2014	Modern Defence repertoire for Black A distinctive, candid specialist work on one of chess's most flexible defences.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority

08 Black - 1.d4 and Flank (9)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Grandmaster Repertoire: King's Indian 1 Gawain Jones (GM) Quality Chess, 2022	King's Indian main lines for Black, including the Mar del Plata and Saemisch A current, elite-practice KID reference with unusually good verbal explanations.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: King's Indian 2 Gawain Jones (GM) Quality Chess, 2022	King's Indian against the Averbakh, Four Pawns, Fianchetto, English, Reti, and sidelines Completes a full Black KID repertoire across 1.d4, 1.c4, and 1.Nf3.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Nimzo-Indian Defence Michael Roiz (GM) Quality Chess, 2017	Complete Nimzo-Indian repertoire for Black A full modern treatment of the most central positional defence to 1.d4.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Grandmaster Repertoire: The Queen's Indian Defence Michael Roiz (GM) Quality Chess, 2018	Complete Queen's Indian repertoire for Black The natural companion to Roiz's Nimzo, covering 3.Nf3 with a strategically rich repertoire.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 20: The Semi-Slav Lars Schandorff (GM) Quality Chess, 2015	Complete Semi-Slav repertoire for Black A serious reference for the sharpest and most important 1.d4 d5 complex.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 12: The Modern Benoni Marian Petrov (GM) Quality Chess, 2013	Complete Modern Benoni repertoire for Black Ensures the shelf covers a major unbalanced counterattacking structure in depth.	Reference Official excerpt installed Specialist priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: Leningrad Dutch Mihail Marin (GM) Quality Chess, 2021	Leningrad Dutch main lines for Black A modern dynamic Dutch repertoire grounded in strategic explanation.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire: Dutch Sidelines Mihail Marin (GM) Quality Chess, 2021	Anti-Dutch move orders and White sidelines after 1...f5 Makes the Leningrad selection genuinely complete against flank and anti-Dutch move orders.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Specialist priority
The Safest Gruenfeld Alexander Delchev and Evgenij Agrest (GMs) Chess Stars, 2011	Complete Gruenfeld repertoire for Black, including Anti-Gruenfeld systems Provides a Black-side Gruenfeld anchor with model games, plans, and concrete theory.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Core priority

09 Sidelines and Specialists (3)

Title and author	Coverage and selection note	Use / status
Grandmaster Repertoire 19: Beating Minor Openings Victor Mikhalevski (GM) Quality Chess, 2016	Black repertoire against 1.Nf3, 1.c4, 1.b3, 1.f4, and other minor first moves Essential breadth: it handles the flank openings that specialized 1.d4 books often omit.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Grandmaster Repertoire 11: Beating 1.d4 Sidelines Boris Avrukh (GM) Quality Chess, 2012	Black repertoire against the Trompowsky, London, Torre, Colle, and other 1.d4 sidelines A canonical clean-up volume for the practical systems most often missing from main-line repertoires.	Reference Official excerpt installed Core priority
Fighting the London System Kiril Georgiev (GM) Chess Stars, 2017	Dedicated Black repertoire and strategic guide against the London System A focused GM treatment of the era's most common system opening, complementing Avrukh's broader sideline coverage.	Hybrid Official excerpt installed Specialist priority

Library handoff

The folder beside this catalogue contains the publisher excerpts arranged into the same shelves. A machine-readable JSON catalogue records title, author, year, publisher, coverage, source style, priority, official URLs, local filename, and selection rationale for every book.

Artifact	Purpose
Opening Books - GM Bestseller Shelf Catalogue.pdf	Human-readable shelf guide and acquisition order
opening-books-catalogue.json	Machine-readable metadata for future indexing and ingestion
PDF validation report.json	Page counts, text extraction status, size, and SHA-256 checksums

Selection is necessarily editorial rather than mathematically objective. The shelf favors established GM authors and respected specialist publishers, while balancing durable prose with theoretical authority. Publication dates are preserved so a future coach can discount old concrete analysis without discarding still-valid strategic explanations.